

# The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

FRIDAY, JULY 3, 2026

## ‘I didn’t write that’: more doubts on signatures

Many say they didn’t sign papers for GOP candidates

By Chris Van Buskirk  
GLOBE STAFF

Andrew Tamburello’s signature was one of hundreds from voters purportedly living in Weymouth that Anne Manning Martin submitted to local officials to help get her name on the Republican primary ballot as a candidate for lieutenant governor.

That was news to Tamburello, who has been living in Florida for more than a year.

“That was definitely not me,” Tamburello, 39, said from Ocala, Fla., where he moved in February 2025. “I actually support Republicans. I used to support [President] Trump. But not anymore. Unfortunately, I don’t trust anybody anymore. It stinks.”

Tamburello is one of a dozen people who, in interviews with the Globe, said they did not sign nomination papers for Manning Martin or Michael Walsh, a Republican candidate for attorney general, even though their signatures — tied to their current or former addresses in Weymouth — appear on documents submitted by the two Republicans’ campaigns.

A state commission in June ruled that hundreds of signatures turned in by Manning Martin were not valid. **SIGNATURES, Page A9**

## Keeping memory of Revolutionary War’s soldiers of color alive

By Carlos Muñoz  
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — Jason Roomes did not learn that his ancestors had fought in the American Revolution until he was in his 40s. His father may have never known. By the time Roomes found records of his family’s history tucked away in a dozen town halls, his father had been dead for decades.

The story is not unusual for descendants of the First Rhode Island Regiment, an infantry of Black, Indigenous, and white soldiers and one of the few regiments that fought for nearly the entire Revolutionary War. The Continental Army promised freedom to any enslaved man willing to fight. It also paid slave owners for the ‘inconvenience’ of sending their “property” into battle.

More than 250 years later, the men who took that deal have yet to be fully remembered as part of America’s Revolutionary history.

“Go around Rhode Island, look at the names, all these different statues, monuments, roads, and bridges with these slave owners’ names,” Roomes said. “There’s none of these Black soldiers who did their part — slaves were brought down to enlist because the owners didn’t want to lose them.”

**REGIMENT, Page A8**



WESTCHESTER COUNTY TOURISM & FILM

Jason Roomes (second from left) with First Rhode Island Regiment reenactors.

## A hot spot for all the wrong reasons

Worcester neighborhood illustrates effects of treeless heat islands

By Danny McDonald  
GLOBE STAFF

WORCESTER — It was cooler in the shade. But here, on one of the hottest streets in one of the hottest neighborhoods in Massachusetts, there is little shade to be had: there are no trees, and plenty of pavement.

That dynamic, combined with a

low elevation in a city known for its hills, means that temperatures can be 10 to 15 degrees hotter than, say, Worcester Regional Airport, located just 5 miles to the west.

Lafayette Street in the Green Island neighborhood of Worcester is a heat island, the type of place where the heat wave underway is hitting particularly hard. The lack of tree

canopy makes it harder to hide from the searing temperatures, while all that asphalt absorbs the sunlight during the day and then radiates the heat at night, keeping the place scorching.

“It just absolutely cooks,” said John Rogan, a Clark University geography professor, a sheen of sweat forming on his brow on a morning

this week.

With temperatures throughout New England hitting 100, heat islands have new resonance, particularly for those who work and live in them, from Springfield to Chelsea to Worcester.

Green Island and other heat islands swelter, in part, because, well, they’re not very green.

According to Rogan and the **HU-HEAT ISLAND, Page A12**

## SUMMER 101

On a sweltering day in July, there was really only one place to be if you were outside Thursday, and that was at the beach. Crowds were blanket to blanket everywhere, particularly at Nantasket Beach in Hull. Boston broke a 63-year-old record for the date by reaching 101 degrees, and if you somehow feel like you didn’t get enough of that extreme heat, Friday will be pretty much the same. **B3.**



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

## Efforts to change state symbols continue to flag

By Kelly Garrity  
GLOBE STAFF

If at first you don’t succeed . . . and on the second try you also don’t succeed . . . start from scratch again?

That seems to be the thinking with the long plodding state commission charged with recommending changes to the state’s seal, flag, and motto.

Members of the 10-member com-

mission met last week for the first time since blowing past a December deadline amid concerns there was still a “public misunderstanding” about why the controversial imagery on the Massachusetts flag and seal — which depicts a Colonist’s arm holding a sword above the image of a Native American — needs to go.

But a six-month gap between

meetings did little to ease those worries, prompting one member to suggest the state — now hundreds of thousands of dollars and a half-decade into finding a replacement — should “restart this whole thing.”

“For the most part, the general public does not have a knowledge of the issues that are underlying the re-

**SYMBOLS, Page A9**

## State GOP finds a cause at Trump fair

Woman’s efforts with Mass. booth mobilize party

By Tal Kopan  
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The Massachusetts Republican Party has a number of priorities. Taxes. Budgets. Immigration. And now — Donna.

More specifically, Donna Festinger, 72, of Greenfield, who single-handedly decided to staff a booth at the Great American State Fair, President Trump’s festival commemorating America’s 250th birthday, on the National Mall.

Festinger, a retired teacher, has spent the better part of a week spending 12 hours a day at the fair, rationing the few donated samples of maple syrup she scraped together as souvenirs for visitors she greets inside the Massachusetts booth. But now, she’s getting reinforcements, and it has become a cause célèbre (and distraction from losing several candidates from the ballot) for the state GOP, which has sharply criticized the state’s

**FAIR, Page A8**

## Why did Celtics do it?

Jaylen Brown thanked the fans and said he’s “excited and disappointed at the same time” about the trade that sent him to the 76ers. Chad Finn analyzes the move from Brad Stevens’ perspective. **C1, 6.**

### Live free or fry

**Friday:** Very hot again. High 95-100. Low 76-81.

**Saturday:** Some storms. High 91-96. Low 69-74.

**Weather and Comics, G6-7.**

VOL. 310, NO. 3

Suggested retail price  
\$4.00



0 947725 4

26516

Helping our customers  
live longer, healthier,  
*better lives*®

John Hancock



Prepare  
for better

Insurance products are issued by: John Hancock Life Insurance Company (U.S.A.), Boston, MA 02116 (not licensed in New York) and John Hancock Life Insurance Company of New York, Valhalla, NY 10595. MLINY061826706-1